

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Forward Deployed AI Analyst role. For three years I have run client engagements through the same arc: SME interviews, document review, system mapping, a written spec, a working agent, and a rollout their team can run. I want that work embedded alongside a Makai lead. I interviewed with Makai last year. An engineering seat was the wrong match, and the business analyst role filled before we finished. This analyst role is that client work. I would start here and grow toward solutions engineering or implementation.

Makai's standard is the one I hold. People stay the final firewall, and the system has to adapt to how the work is already done. On the MRO medical-forms engagement, the interface doubled productivity even with auto-extraction turned off. That is the part I care about: the human path is part of the product, not a fallback when the model misses.

How I would run an engagement:

- **Discovery through spec:** SME interviews, document review, and system mapping, then a product spec for what to automate and what to leave manual. I completed IBM's Business Process Modeling coursework in April 2026.
- **Prototype and evaluation:** Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, n8n, and Claude Code. On a content-scoring workflow I designed the prompts and rubric from the client's ground truth, QA-tested them with their reviewers, and held deployment to 95% agreement.
- **Rollout and ROI:** I automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments and trained their team to run and extend the workflow. Processing time fell 98% against a measured baseline.
- **What not to build:** At Wiz Music I showed that reported community growth was not organic and raised it, instead of automating a number that would not survive a closer look.

Agile delivery for me is GitHub and Notion. I have not used Jira, Azure DevOps, a process-mining product, or financial models. I map processes with interviews and BPMN, and I measure with operating dashboards and productivity against a baseline. I am based in Emeryville, I can hold Eastern Time overlap, and I can start before summer 2027 if you have an earlier full-time seat.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome a conversation about how an analyst decides a workflow is worth a prototype on your platform, and when to stop after discovery.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker